

CLEAR Checklist & Scenario Cards

Communicating Up: Building Confidence Across Generations

Program	New Intern Onboarding
Use	Post-session job aid and workshop activity cards
Version	v1.0

CLEAR Communication Checklist

Use this checklist before sending a manager update, asking a question, or following up after a meeting.

CLEAR	Question to Ask Yourself	Example
C - Context	Did I explain the situation briefly?	I am working on the safety report draft due Thursday.
L - Lead with the point	Did I state the main message or request early?	I have one question about the incident-rate calculation.
E - Explain briefly	Did I include only the details the manager needs?	The monthly dashboard and export show different totals.
A - Ask or action	Did I make a specific ask or state my next action?	Could you confirm which source I should use?
R - Recap next step	Did I confirm deadline, owner, or follow-up?	Once confirmed, I can complete the draft by Thursday afternoon.

Quick Message Template

Hi **[Name]**, I am working on [context]. [Lead with the point]. [Brief explanation]. Could you [specific ask]? Once confirmed, I will [next step/deadline].

Professional Tone Checklist

Before Sending, Check...	Yes / Not Yet
The purpose is clear in the first one or two sentences.	
The tone is respectful and appropriate for the audience.	
The request is specific.	
The message includes a deadline or next step when needed.	
Unnecessary details, apologies, or casual language have been removed.	

Scenario Cards

Cut these into individual cards for in-person delivery, or paste them into breakout room chats for virtual delivery.

Card 1: Clarifying a Task

Your manager asks you to “prepare a short update” for next week, but you do not know the audience, format, or length. Write 2-3 clarifying questions.

Response: _____

Card 2: Following Up

You sent a draft yesterday and need feedback by 3 p.m. today to meet tomorrow’s deadline. Write a professional follow-up message.

Response: _____

Card 3: Escalating a Delay

You discover that one required data file is missing, which may delay your analysis. Write a message that explains the issue, impact, and proposed next step.

Response: _____

Card 4: Responding to Feedback

Your manager says your report has useful information but is too detailed for leadership. Write a professional response and next step.

Response: _____

Card 5: Speaking in a Meeting

You are in a project meeting and notice that two action items are unclear. Write one sentence you could use to clarify ownership and deadline.

Response: _____

Card 6: Asking for Help Without Sounding Unprepared

You tried two possible solutions but are still stuck. Write a message that explains what you tried and what specific help you need.

Response: _____

